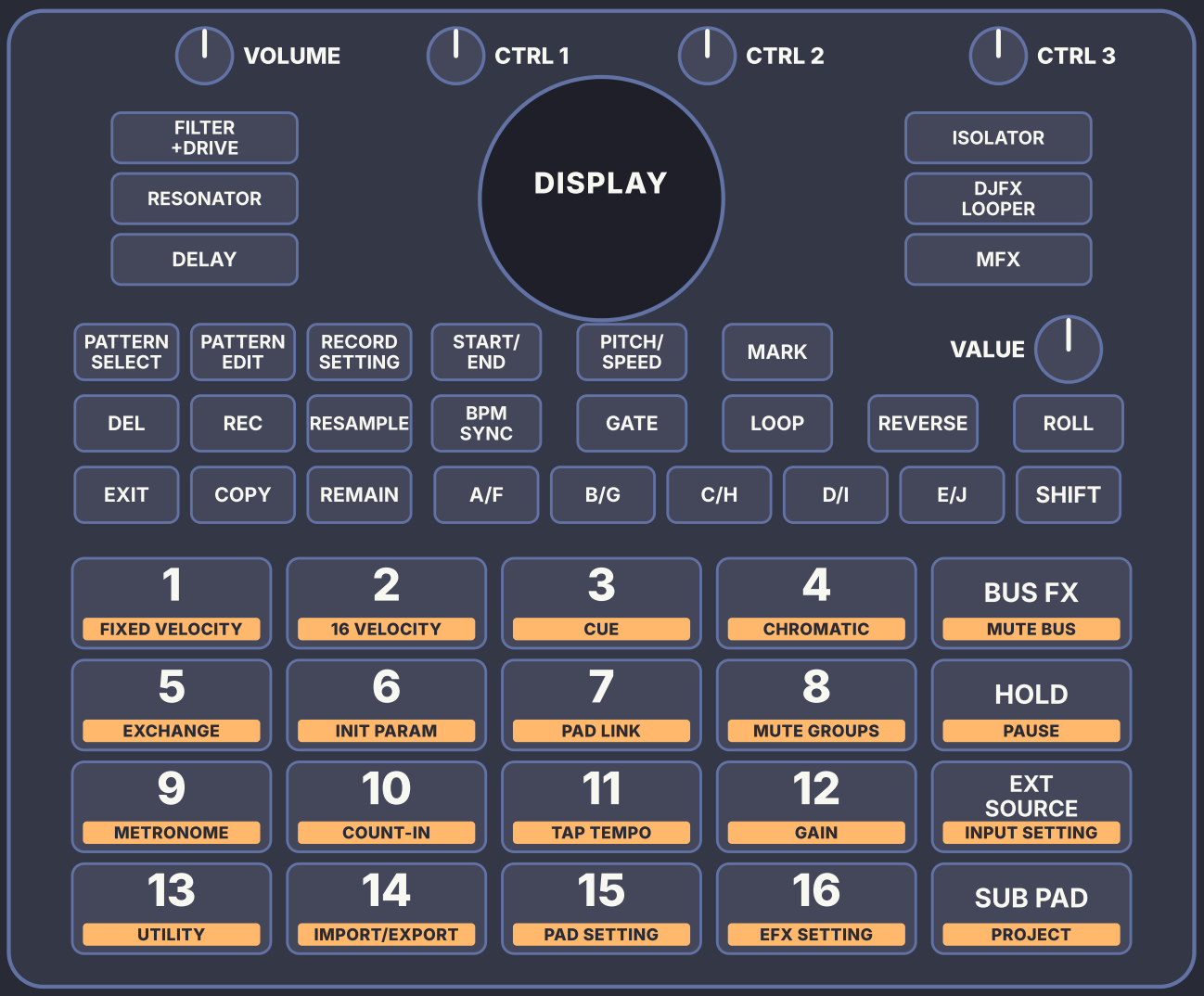
SP-404MKII · stock OS

Pocket cheat sheet & panel map for the Roland SP-404MKII (firmware v4.00 shortcuts)



HOLD this key · PRESS / TAP this key · TURN this knob · (1) order of steps
orange bar = printed SHIFT function for that pad

WHERE THINGS LIVE

- **Display + FX row** – effect buttons FILTER+DRIVE, RESONATOR, DELAY (left) and ISOLATOR, DJFX LOOPER, MFX (right) flank the display.
- **Knobs** – VOLUME, CTRL 1–3 (effect / edit parameters) and VALUE (turn to select, press to confirm).
- **Left block** – PATTERN SELECT, PATTERN EDIT, RECORD SETTING / DEL, REC, RESAMPLE / EXIT, COPY, REMAIN.
- **Right block** – START/END, PITCH/SPEED, MARK / BPM SYNC, GATE, LOOP, REVERSE, ROLL / banks A/F–E/J and SHIFT.
- **Pads** – 16 pads numbered left→right, top→bottom. The column on their right: BUS FX, HOLD, EXT SOURCE, SUB PAD.

GOLDEN RULES

- **SHIFT** gives a pad or button its alternate function while held (orange labels).
- **EXIT** backs out or cancels. Stop everything: **SHIFT** + **EXIT**.
- **Banks**: 10 banks via **A/F**–**E/J**; press **A/F** to toggle A and F. For banks F–J press the bank button twice so it blinks.
- **Buses**: **BUS FX** switches the selected bus – solid orange = BUS 1, blinking orange = BUS 2.
- **Live safety**: hold **SHIFT** + hold **REMAIN** for 3 s = LIVE MODE (locks edit buttons).
- Combos read **hold + press**: the first key is held, the second tapped.

BOOKLET MAP

p2 Sampling
REC · skip-back · resample · merge · copy · delete

p3 Play & edit
gate · loop · roll · velocity · mute · chop · live mode

p4 Patterns
record · TR-REC · chain · edit · tempo

p5 FX & system
buses · MFX · projects · utility

p6 DJ & SHIFT
DJ mode · SHIFT table · pad grid

Unofficial cheat sheet compiled from Roland's SP-404MK2 Reference Manual and v4.00 List of Shortcut Keys (static.roland.com). Not affiliated with Roland. Diagrams are schematic, not to scale. Check the Roland documents for anything safety- or data-critical.

Sampling

Record · skip-back · resample · merge · copy · swap · delete · banks

Sample (REC)



Press **REC** – empty pads blink red. Press a blinking pad (destination). Press **REC** to start; press the pad or **REC** again to stop. **CTRL 2** sets length; **EXIT** cancels.

Skip-back sampling (MARK)



Play a sample or pattern (or use **EXT SOURCE**); **MARK** blinks while audio is buffered. Press **MARK** (waveform shown), press **REC** ("Select Pad To Save"), then a pad. **EXIT** discards. **SHIFT** + press **VALUE** switches **MARK** between skip-back and Looper.

Resample
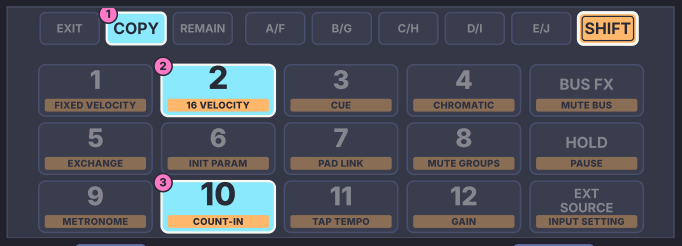


Press **RESAMPLE**; **CTRL 2** sets length; **RECORD SETTING** > ROUTING = Mix; press **EXIT** or **RESAMPLE**. Press a blinking pad, then a pad to begin (starts when the pattern plays). Press the pad or **REC** to stop.

Sample merge



SHIFT + **RESAMPLE**. Press up to four pads. **CTRL 1** picks SUM or MUL; **CTRL 3** sets levels; press **VALUE** to run. Press the destination pad, then **VALUE**.

Copy · swap a sample



Copy: **COPY**, source pad, destination pad, then **VALUE** or **COPY** to confirm (overwrites). Swap: **SHIFT** + **pad 5**, press two pads, then **VALUE** or **COPY**.

Delete a sample



One pad: **DEL**, the pad, then **VALUE** or **DEL**. Whole bank: hold **DEL** + **EXIT**, press the bank button, then **VALUE** or **DEL**.

Do this	Input	Notes
Copy a bank	hold **COPY** + **EXIT**	Select the source bank, turn **VALUE** to move the cursor, then select the destination bank
Protect a bank	bank button(s), then **SHIFT** + **COPY**	Choose OK with **VALUE** and press it. Repeat to remove protection. Stops samples/patterns being copied over, edited over or deleted
Bank volume	**SHIFT** + bank button **A/F** – **E/J**	Overall volume of that bank
Count-in · metronome	**SHIFT** + **pad 10** · **SHIFT** + **pad 9**	Count-in cycles 1MEAS, 2MEAS, WAIT, OFF
Sound generator	**SHIFT** + **RECORD SETTING**	Switches to sound generator mode
Input settings	**SHIFT** + **EXT SOURCE**	Opens the input settings screen

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Play & edit

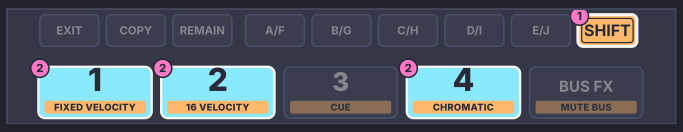
Gate · loop · roll · velocity · mute · live mode · chop · bank-wide edits

GATE · LOOP · REVERSE · ROLL · HOLD



GATE toggles (with **SHIFT** = whole bank). **LOOP** on; add **REVERSE** for reverse looping; **SHIFT** + **LOOP** = ping-pong. **ROLL**: hold + pad, or press during playback; **SHIFT** + **ROLL** cycles the interval. **HOLD**: with GATE on, hold pads then press **HOLD**.

Velocity & chromatic



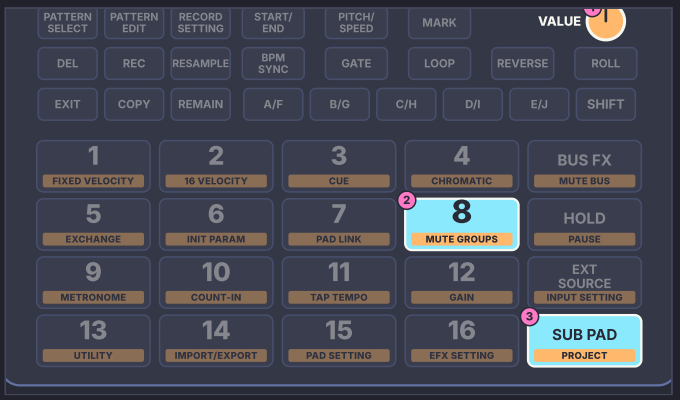
SHIFT + **pad 1** FIXED VELOCITY (always 127) · **SHIFT** + **pad 2** 16 VELOCITY · **SHIFT** + **pad 4** CHROMATIC (pads play pitches as a scale).

Pad mute



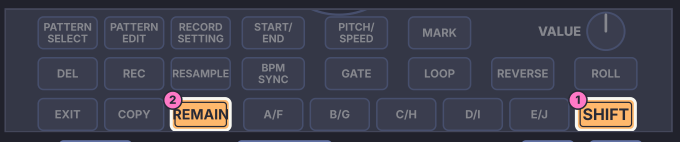
Hold **SHIFT** + **REVERSE**, then press pads 1–16 to mute/unmute. Add **REMAIN** to latch SHIFT and REVERSE so you can let go.

Select silently · timing



Hold **VALUE** + pad selects a sample with no sound (a pattern if PATTERN SELECT is lit). Hold **VALUE** + **SUB PAD** minimises timing differences when playing several samples together.

Live mode



Hold **SHIFT** and hold **REMAIN** for 3 s. While on, **DEL**, **REC**, **RESAMPLE**, **COPY** and **MARK** are disabled. Repeat to turn off.

Edit / marker tool	Input	Notes
CHOP	**SHIFT** + **START/END**	Or: add markers with **MARK**, press **VALUE**, choose ASSIGN TO PAD, press target pads, set marker with **CTRL 2**, order pads with **VALUE**, **MARK** confirms, **VALUE** assigns
ENVELOPE	**SHIFT** + **PITCH/SPEED**	Fade-in / fade-out (ATTACK, HOLD, RELEASE)
Edit a whole bank	hold **REMAIN** + knob on the PITCH/SPEED or ENVELOPE screen	Applies SPEED, PITCH, VOLUME, PAN, BPM, BPM SYNC, GATE, LOOP, REVERSE (and ATTACK/HOLD/RELEASE) to every sample in the bank
Edit a mute group	hold **COPY** + same knobs	Same parameters, but only samples in the same mute group
Switch-all	**SHIFT** + **GATE** · **SHIFT** + **BPM SYNC**	GATE ALL / SYNC ALL on or off for the selected bank
One-shot mode	hold **VALUE** + **GATE**	Toggles one-shot playback
Sample tempo	**PITCH/SPEED**, pick pad, **VALUE**	BPM SET = AUTO or MANU
Stop all · pause	**SHIFT** + **EXIT** · **SHIFT** + **HOLD**	Stops all playing samples · pauses everything playing

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Patterns

Record · TR-REC · chain · edit · quantize · tempo

Record a pattern (real-time)



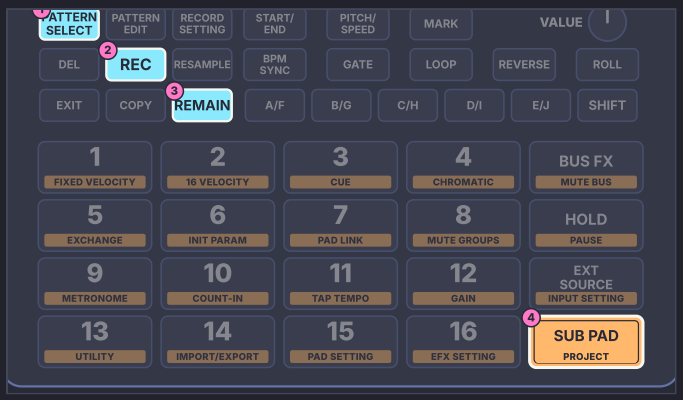
PATTERN SELECT, then **REC** (empty pads blink red). Press a blinking pad. Press **REMAIN** for Real-Time. **CTRL 1** BPM · **CTRL 2** LENGTH · **CTRL 3** STRENGTH · **VALUE** QTZ. Press **REC** to start. **EXIT** once = finish & save; again = stop playback. While recording, **REC** toggles rehearsal ↔ recording.

Tempo · count-in · metronome



SHIFT + **pad 9** metronome · **SHIFT** + **pad 10** count-in · **SHIFT** + **pad 11** opens TEMPO SEL: **CTRL 1** picks PROJECT or BANK A–J, **VALUE** sets, **EXIT**. Tap tempo: tap **SUB PAD** in time, then **EXIT**.

TR-REC (step sequencer)



PATTERN SELECT, **REC**, blinking pad, **REMAIN** for TR-REC. **CTRL 1** BPM · **CTRL 2** LENGTH · **CTRL 3** SHUFFLE. **REC** begins. Hold **SUB PAD** + a pad to pick the sample; pads 1–16 place steps; **VALUE** moves to the next measure; **EXIT** twice to finish. Also **SHIFT** + **REC** while a pattern plays.

Pattern chain



Create: **PATTERN SELECT**, hold **HOLD** + a pad (chain number), press pads to add patterns, **EXIT** saves. Repeat: **REMAIN** toggles; **START/END** cycles REPEAT All / Current / Off. Play: hold **HOLD** + chain pad; **SUB PAD** start/stop; **EXIT** leaves.

Pattern edit & quantize



PATTERN SELECT, **PATTERN EDIT**, the pattern pad. **CTRL 1** BPM · **CTRL 2** LOOP START · **CTRL 3** LENGTH; **VALUE** menu: DUPLICATE (doubles) or CROP (keeps loop range). Quantize: **RECORD SETTING**, press sample pads, **CTRL 2** QTZ · **CTRL 3** STR · **SHIFT** + **CTRL 2** QS · **SHIFT** + **CTRL 3** QE, **VALUE** > OK (can't be undone).

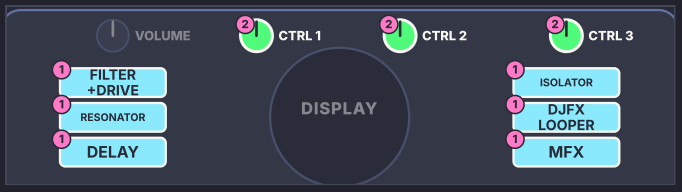
Do this	Input	Notes
Undo last input	**SHIFT** + **PATTERN SELECT**	Only while recording a pattern
Pattern bank	bank **A/F** – **E/J** while PATTERN SELECT is lit	**A/F** toggles A/F; double-press for F–J
Delete notes (TR-REC)	**DEL** + **A/F** · **DEL** + **B/G**	One measure for the selected pad · for all pads
Record knob motion (TR-REC)	**ROLL** + **CTRL 1** / **CTRL 2** / **CTRL 3**	Needs MODE = TRIG
Delete EFX motion · pad mutes	**DEL** + **MARK** · **DEL** + **REVERSE**	On the pattern edit screen
Select pattern silently	hold **VALUE** + pad	While PATTERN SELECT is lit (pattern does not play)

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FX, routing & system

Buses · MFX · effect grab · projects · utility · import / export

Effects & buses



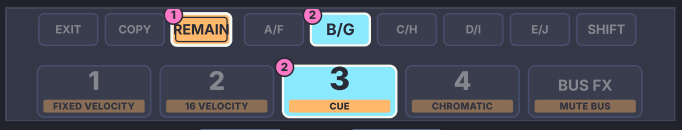
Press **BUS FX** to pick the bus (solid orange BUS 1 · blinking BUS 2). With a bus selected, press an effect button (FILTER+DRIVE … MFX) to assign it. Play a pad and edit with **CTRL 1–3**.

MFX list



Hold **MFX** and turn **VALUE** or **CTRL 3**; release **MFX** to switch on. Hold **MFX** + **DJFX LOOPER** for the list from #17, **MFX** + **ISOLATOR** from #33.

Route a sample to a bus



Select BUS 2 with **BUS FX**, hold **REMAIN**, press a pad: orange = BUS 1, green = BUS 2, white = dry. Hold **REMAIN** + a bank button sets the send for every sample in that bank.

Effects & routing	Input	Result
Effect grab	hold **VALUE** + effect button	Effect applies only while the button is held
Mute bus	**SHIFT** + **BUS FX**	Silences the bus send, so only the effect is heard
Swap BUS 1 / BUS 2	hold **REMAIN** + **BUS FX**	Swaps the two buses' effects (parameters kept)
Bypass BUS 3 & 4	hold **VALUE** + **BUS FX**	Temporary bypass
Keep MFX screen open	hold **REMAIN** + **MFX**	Effect edit screen stays displayed
Save EFX parameters	**SHIFT** + hold **MARK** 3 s	Saves main parameters of BUS 1 / BUS 2 effects
EFX settings (BUS 3/4)	**SHIFT** + **pad 16**	UTILITY > EFX SET

System & projects	Input	Result
Select project	**SHIFT** + **SUB PAD**, then pad 1–16	SELECT PROJECT screen
Copy · delete project	**SHIFT** + **SUB PAD**, then **COPY** (source pad, destination pad) or **DEL** (pad), then **VALUE**	Copy overwrites the destination
Utility menu	**SHIFT** + **pad 13**	Also: **pad 12** GAIN · **pad 15** PAD SET
Import / export	**SHIFT** + **pad 14**	Samples or projects, to / from SD card
Headphone CUE	**SHIFT** + **pad 3**	**CTRL 3** balances C (cue) ↔ M (main); **EXIT** leaves
Input settings	**SHIFT** + **EXT SOURCE**	Also toggles external input on/off with **EXT SOURCE**

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DJ mode & SHIFT table

DJ shortcuts · every SHIFT + button · pad functions · community extras

DJ mode (enter: banks D/I + E/J together)	Input
Mute CH1 / CH2	SHIFT + REVERSE + pad 13 / pad 15
Play from marker	SHIFT + pads 1–16 (latch SHIFT with SHIFT + REMAIN; EXIT cancels)
Add · edit · delete markers	SHIFT + MARK · SHIFT + START/END · SHIFT + DEL + pad
Roll size · roll	SHIFT + ROLL (1/4, 1/2, 1, 2 bars) · ROLL + pad 13 / pad 15
Change roll while rolling	ROLL + pads 1–4 (¼ · ½ · 1 · 2 bars)
Bus per channel	hold REMAIN + pad 14 (CH1) / pad 16 (CH2): BUS-1 → BUS-2 → DRY
CTRL 3 function	START/END switches CUE MIX ↔ X-FADE
Mixer ↔ EFX view	MARK
Fader curve	hold RESAMPLE + press VALUE: FAST CUT → LINEAR → SQUARE → CUBIC
Reset BPM	DEL + pads 2 + 6 (CH1) / 4 + 8 (CH2)
BPM digits · reverse channel	PITCH/SPEED · BPM SYNC (picks CH for REVERSE)

SHIFT +	Function	SHIFT +	Function
bank A/F – E/J	BANK VOLUME	GATE	GATE ALL ON/OFF
COPY	BANK PROTECT	BPM SYNC	SYNC ALL ON/OFF
LOOP	PING-PONG LOOP	REC	TR-REC (pattern playing)
ROLL	ROLL SET	RESAMPLE	SAMPLE MERGE
START/END	CHOP	RECORD SETTING	SOUND GENERATOR
PITCH/SPEED	ENVELOPE	EXIT	STOP all samples
PATTERN SELECT	UNDO (recording)	HOLD	PAUSE
REMAIN 3 s	LIVE MODE	BUS FX	MUTE BUS
MARK 3 s	SAVE EFX PARAMETER	EXT SOURCE	INPUT SETTING
VALUE (press)	MARK = skip-back ↔ Looper	SUB PAD	PROJECT

PAD SHIFT FUNCTIONS

1 FIXED VELOCITY	2 16 VELOCITY	3 CUE	4 CHROMATIC
5 EXCHANGE	6 INIT PARAM	7 PAD LINK	8 MUTE GROUPS
9 METRONOME	10 COUNT-IN	11 TAP TEMPO	12 GAIN
13 UTILITY	14 IMPORT/EXPORT	15 PAD SETTING	16 EFX SETTING

COMMUNITY EXTRAS – NOT IN ROLAND'S LIST

From the SP-404MK2 Workflow Cheat Sheet v5.50 by vultilion (CC BY-NC 4.0); **not verified against Roland's documents**: rename sample – hold REMAIN + click VALUE · numerical start/end edit – SHIFT + VALUE · preview loop end – ROLL · waveform zoom – turn / hold VALUE · Koala: PATTERN EDIT opens piano roll / mixer · Serato: pads 1–8 play sampler slots, banks A–D pick Studio decks 1–4.

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